

# Expertise Boundary Clinic Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Cross-AOK • 30-40 min

|            |           |      |                           |
|------------|-----------|------|---------------------------|
| Category   | Cross-AOK | Time | 30-40 min                 |
| Difficulty | Medium    | ID   | expertise-boundary-clinic |

Big idea: Expertise is powerful evidence within boundaries, but those boundaries must be identified.

## Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

## Concrete Stimulus Packet

|                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus A     | Student-facing stimulus 1: Expert: climate scientist; claims about atmospheric data, energy policy, election strategy, and personal lifestyle choices. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply. | Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.                                                                  |
| Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus B     | Student-facing stimulus 2: Expert: novelist; claims about narrative technique, historical fact, psychology, and moral value. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.                           | Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.                                                                                          |
| Expertise Boundary Clinic Reveal / Twist | Student-facing stimulus 3: Expert: novelist; claims about narrative technique, historical fact, psychology, and moral value. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.                           | Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Expertise is powerful evidence within boundaries, but those boundaries must be identified. |

## Actual Lesson Questions

| # | Question for students                                                                      |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | After inspecting Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim? |
| 2 | Which exact detail from Expertise Boundary Clinic Stimulus A did you use as evidence?      |
| 3 | What did you infer beyond the evidence?                                                    |
| 4 | How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?                                   |
| 5 | What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?                           |
| 6 | When is expert authority a good reason to believe?                                         |

## Ready-to-Use Examples

- Expert: climate scientist; claims about atmospheric data, energy policy, election strategy, and personal lifestyle choices.
- Expert: novelist; claims about narrative technique, historical fact, psychology, and moral value.

## Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Cross-AOK.

## Activity Steps

1. Give groups an expert profile and several claims the expert might make.
2. Students decide which claims fall inside, near, or outside the expert's domain.
3. Groups identify what extra evidence would be needed for each claim.
4. Compare cases where expertise should carry more or less weight.
5. Debrief responsible trust in knowledge communities.

## Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

| What I noticed | What I inferred | Evidence | Confidence |
|----------------|-----------------|----------|------------|
|                |                 |          |            |
|                |                 |          |            |
|                |                 |          |            |

## TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: When is expert authority a good reason to believe?
- How can knowers respect expertise without surrendering judgement?
- What counts as overreach beyond a domain of knowledge?

## Knowledge Questions

- When is expert authority a good reason to believe?
- How should knowers identify the limits of expertise?
- Can trust and critical thinking work together?

## Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with experts make claims inside and outside their field. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

## Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...